Today's goals

Complete any 3 learning items - 3/3
Watch 2 videos - 2/2
Complete a graded assessment

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

- Welcome to the course! Reading • 10 min
- Preview What Is Contemporary Art? Video • 51 sec
- Course instructors respond: what is contemporary art? Reading • 10 min
- Suggestions for making the most of the course Reading • 10 min
- Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection Reading • 10 min

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Source It
- Introduction to Module 2 Reading • 10 min
- Arthur Jafa, APEX, 2013 Reading • 10 min
- In the studio with Arthur Jafa | "The place where images overlap is you" Video • 3 min
- Three approaches to appropriation Reading • 10 min

Share It
- How do artists and architects share and circulate images? Reading • 10 min
- Beatriz González on her street posters in Bogotá, 1983 Video • 2 min
- Two interventions in television and architecture Reading • 10 min
- Alfredo Jaar on Lament of the Images, 2002 Video • 1 min
- Dayanita Singh on Museum of Chance, 2013 Video • 3 min

Watch It
- How are images used to watch and classify us? Reading • 10 min
- **Surveilling, seeing, scanning** Reading • 10 min

Play It
- What do video games and computers have to do with art and design? Reading • 10 min
- Susan Kare on designing the first Mac icons, 1980s Video • 3 min
- JODI on turning desktop order inside out Reading • 10 min
- Serious games and artificial intelligence Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- Memory Check Practice Assignment
- Reflect on Module 2 Learnings Dialogue • 15 min
- Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Module 6
Power

# Surveilling, seeing, scanning

3:28 / 4:45 1x

### Deborah Stratman, *In Order Not To Be Here*, 2002

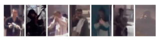


Deborah Stratman. Still from *In Order Not to Be Here*. 2002. 16mm film (color, sound) 34 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase from the artist

Deborah Stratman places us in a surveillance position throughout her foreboding take on suburban America, *In Order Not To Be Here*. The film opens with actual police footage: a bird's-eye-view of the pursuit of two suspects, guided by the voice of an officer who radioes their coordinates to his colleagues on the ground. From this footage, Stratman cuts to shot after shot of suburbia as it slumbers. Empty strip mall parking lots, a glowing McDonald's, a blond child asleep inside a comfortable home—these and more coalesce into a picture of a place shaped by its residents' need to feel safe, to cordon themselves off with security cameras, guards, and walls. Stratman's nighttime filming and heightened, at times discordant, soundtrack sustain an atmosphere of menace. She emphasizes this sense of fear by ending the film as she opened it, with a second police chase (this one staged by the artist). For several harrowing minutes, we see infrared footage shot from a helicopter chasing after a running figure who ultimately disappears into a body of water.

**Watch an excerpt of *In Order Not To Be Here*.**

### Rabih Mroué, *The Fall of a Hair: Blow Ups*, 2012

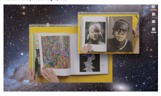


Rabih Mroue. *The Fall of a Hair: Blow Ups*. 2012. Pigmented inkjet prints, each 51 3/16 × 35 7/16" (130 × 90 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Rabih Mroué. Commissioned and produced by dOCUMENTA (13) / with the support of Sfeir-Semler Gallery, Beirut/Hamburg. Courtesy Sfeir-Semler Gallery, Beirut - Hamburg

When protests against Syrian President Bashar al-Assad erupted in 2011, Rabih Mroué became interested in the cellphone videos people were posting online: "I found out that some of the activists were circulating instructions.… on how to shoot a demonstration in a secure manner." In response, he began *The Pixelated Revolution*, a multi-part project including a display of seven large-scale photographs titled, *The Fall of a Hair: Blow Ups*.

In each photograph, a man stands pointing a gun. Mroué pulled these images from cellphone videos at the moment when the gunmen and the protesters recording them made eye contact. The resulting stills resemble surveillance camera frames, but in this case the surveillance is mutual as both the gunmen and the protesters were watching each other. The consequences of being seen differ dramatically, however: for the protesters it often meant getting shot. Long interested in how death is presented in images of war, Mroué was prompted to make this work when a friend commented that the protesters were "shooting their own deaths"—a phrase evoking both firing guns and filming or photographing.

### Camille Henrot, *Grosse Fatigue*, 2013



Camille Henrot. Still from *Grosse Fatigue*. 2013. Video (color, sound), 13 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 ADAGP Camille Henrot. Courtesy the artist, Silex Films, and Kamel Mennour, Paris

Camille Henrot's extensive research across a range of disciplines like philosophy, anthropology, and history often shapes her work, including *Grosse Fatigue*. She made the video while in residence at the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, D.C., digging into its vast collections to pull together images of objects and specimens, like animal skeletons and carved figurines, with footage she shot in offices and collection storage. Henrot merges this with additional video clips and images she both made and found online.

Characterizing her structuring of *Grosse Fatigue* as "an experience of density itself," she frames this material in layered pop-up windows that continually open and close against the changing background of a computer desktop. Brief pauses in the pacing stand out in Henrot's otherwise rapid-fire sequencing. Sometimes, a woman's hands appear in the frames, nails playfully manicured to match the colorful backgrounds. A spoken word-style voiceover, which interweaves stories of creation from across cultures, structures the visual cacophony. Henrot describes this mash-up of scientific discovery and religious myth-making as an "intuitive unfolding of knowledge," a presentation meant to highlight our abundance of information, as well as its limits.

**Watch an excerpt of *Grosse Fatigue*.**

Mark as completed

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